THE ELECTRIC FUTURE

HERO MOTOCORP'S BRAND NEW VIDA V1 PRO ANNOUNCES THE COMPANY'S ENTRY INTO THE ELECTRIC MOBILITY SPACE

BY RAHUL GHOSH



Hero Vida V1 Pro
Engine electric motor
Max power 6kW
Battery 3.9kWh
Range 165km (claimed)
Price Rs 1.59 lakh (ex-showroom, Delhi)

The Vida brand takes charge of Hero MotoCorp's electric scooter movement with the launch of the V1 Pro and the V1 Plus. We rode the Pro, which is the top-of-the-line version with a bigger battery and more performance. The front end is dominated by a large LED headlight and then there is a small windscreen flanked by motorcycle-type LED winkers. The telescopic front suspension is a good move and the scooter rides on smart alloy wheels. The 7-inch colour display is bright and easy to read even under harsh sunlight. It comes with a twin-seat setup housing two compartments, one for the removable battery packs while the other offers space for storage. In all, 26 litres of cargo space is offered. A low floor thanks to the batteries sitting under the rider's seat makes for a comfortable riding position. The seat height is also friendly at 780mm. At the back, there is an LED tail light along with sleek winkers. Combined with the snazzy colour palette, the Vida V1 Pro is quite a looker then.



The Hero Vida V1 Pro is powered by two removable lithium-ion batteries with a capacity of 1.97kWh each. While these can be pulled out for a recharge, the scooter can also be charged directly using a dedicated plug. Hero MotoCorp claims an overall range of 165km on a single charge, which is rather good. One can also fast-charge the scooter up to 80 per cent in 65 minutes. The scooter comes with Eco, Ride and Sport modes, besides a custom mode. The V1 Pro can sprint to 40kmph in 3.2 seconds and keep going until it reaches 80kmph. It stays planted on the tarmac at higher speeds and inspires confidence to go faster. In case one needs to overtake in a hurry, all that is needed is to turn the throttle to the max. The scooter moves to a 'boost' mode and delivers the max power momentarily. It is extremely agile, enabling it to change lanes or cut through traffic with ease.

The Hero Vida V1 Pro offers a comfortable riding position, which, for us, is the most important thing. The range is respectable, too, and the fact that the batteries are removable is just fantastic. The only point of contention is the price, which is on the higher side. However, you are getting a scooter from Hero MotoCorp and that's worth the premium. ■